

10 YEARS LATER

Way out of our depth

Memories are short, but Snowmageddon won't soon be forgotten



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

The winter of 2014-2015 was slow to get going, but when it did in late January, snow records started falling.



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Snow is on the radar this weekend

It's been a cold winter but not a particularly snowy one, with several small events like Thursday's (above, a scooter wheeling through the slop in Kenmore Square). Something more substantial is forecast for Saturday night and Sunday morning, potentially the biggest snowstorm all winter in the Boston area.

By Ken Mahan
GLOBE STAFF
and Chris Gloninger
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

It was some of the wildest snow New England has ever seen. Bigger than the Blizzard of '78. And it brought Boston and much of the region to its knees.

The snow was so high for nearly four weeks in January and February 2015 that homes, schools, and businesses were buried. Homeowners used axes to chip away at their icy roofs. Residents and pets stranded in their homes had to be dug out. With nowhere to put the snow, schools were canceled. Towering snowbanks dwarfed everything in sight and Boston's transit system came to a halt.

Snowmageddon, as it came to be called, dumped nearly 8 feet of snow between Jan. 24 and Feb. 22 that year. After a quiet start to the winter, that final stretch of January propelled the Boston area to a staggering 110.6 inches of snow by the time March came to a close, making it the snowiest winter on record.

"The first storm in January, I think the most attention was out in Worcester where the totals were stacking up quickly, and in Marshfield where the storm was pounding the coast," said Nick Emmons, who covered the storms as

SNOW, Page A8

Judges block Trump's plans for overhaul

Musk's efforts to strip government facing hurdles

By Zach Montague
and Madeleine Ngo
NEW YORK TIMES

Federal judges put further brakes on President Trump's sweeping remake of the US government on Thursday, with one in Massachusetts temporarily barring officials from pushing out thousands of government employees through a deferred resignation package.

Judge George O'Toole Jr. stopped the Office of Personnel Management from moving forward with the program until a court hearing in Boston on Monday.

The resignation offer, which was set to expire by midnight

Thursday, is part of a wide-ranging effort by Trump and billionaire Elon Musk to drastically cut the size of the federal government.

Another federal judge issued a temporary restraining order limiting the ability of Musk's associates to access a Treasury Department government payments system. The order, which the Justice Department agreed to, freezes the current situation — as described by a government lawyer at a hearing Thursday — in place.

That means two Musk associates who have been hired as "special government employees" at the Treasury Department can continue to access data from the system, but with "read only" access and no ability to change anything. They can't share the information with Musk or others

TRUMP, Page A6

Living in fear, immigrants choose to stay out of sight

By Edward Fitzpatrick, Omar Mohammed,
and Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — A patient at Providence's Clínica Esperanza fractured his ankle and needed surgery, but he refused to go to the hospital. He was afraid he'd wake up after surgery in handcuffs because of his immigration status.

But if the man doesn't get surgery, he will end up with a disability for the rest of his life, clinic executive director Morgan Leonard said.

"The fear is real," Leonard said. "The consequences are real."

The Trump administration's immigration rhetoric and policies are stirring fears and sparking rumors among many undocumented families throughout New England, prompting people to avoid schools, health clinics, stores, and other public places, officials said.

The impact is especially noticeable in places such as East Boston, which has a large Latin American population, and in tiny Central Falls, R.I., a 1.2-square-mile majority-Latino city of 22,500 people with many undocumented residents.

IMMIGRANTS, Page A7

Trump digs in

The president defended his Gaza proposal, but said he wouldn't use US troops. **A3.**

Drastic cuts

The number of USAID workers will reportedly be slashed from more than 10,000 to 290. **A5.**

'Is this really happening to us?'

Cold, snow, wind force hikers to call for rescue in White Mountains

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

Kathryn McKee knows how to prepare for subzero conditions. Trained in high-altitude and winter conditions, she made sure to bring lights, snowshoes, emergency gear, and extra battery packs for her hike in the White Mountains last weekend.

But after a long day traversing some of the highest points of the Presidentials, she and her hiking partner found themselves snowed in at 5,000 feet up with night falling.

In fear for their lives, they called 911 and waited for rescue, hardly believing their predicament.

"We thought, 'Is this really happening to us?'" McKee said.

For nearly eight hours, McKee, 51, and her partner, Beata Lelacheur, 54, huddled in the darkness, waiting for a search team to make its way through subzero temperatures and sustained winds of 50 to 60 miles per hour.

McKee is back home in Southborough after a brief stay in the hospital. Even now, she still has no feeling in four of her fingers, but realizes she could have been in far worse shape.

"It was touch-and-go for a bit there," she said Wednesday.

RESCUE, Page A8

As state falls behind on housing, an ambitious goal

Between 2010 and 2020, the state built roughly **19,000** homes each year. And that pace has slowed recently. Only **11,600** permits for new homes were issued in 2023.

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

The Healey administration on Thursday laid out a new goal for housing construction that captured the staggering scale of the challenge facing Massachusetts: nearly a quarter-million new homes in just the next 10 years.

In a state infamous for construction delays and opposition to new housing of all kinds, the analysis from a committee appointed by Governor Maura Healey crystallizes the severity of the housing shortage in Massachusetts that is warping the lives of everyday people and could worsen if the state

does not begin building faster.

It also adds a new sense of urgency to a problem that has persisted for years: Massachusetts is well behind the pace needed to meet its new goal, 220,000 new homes, by 2035. While the state built an average of 19,000 residences a year between 2010 and 2020, the pace has since slowed markedly: Only 11,600 permits for new homes were issued in 2023.

The new official housing goal is more ambitious than that set by former governor Charlie Baker, but getting there will not be easy. Interest rates and other financial headwinds like the cost of land and materials

have made it more difficult than ever to finance construction of apartments, and municipalities are fighting efforts to make it easier to build within their borders.

"At the root of our challenge with costs is a shortage of homes," Healey said at an event announcing the housing goals Thursday. "It's a shortage that . . . has built up over many years as our state was not building the housing that we needed to keep pace with our economic growth."

"Building these housing units [is] going to help us bring down costs, and keep our economy competitive."

HOUSING, Page A4

Dell Technologies is the latest company to call workers back five days a week, potentially affecting thousands of the company's employees in Massachusetts. **BS.**

Scientists withdrew plans to conduct a controversial geoengineering experiment off Martha's Vineyard. **B1.**

Some of the most important data sets tracking trends in the US population have disappeared from the US Census Bureau's website in recent days. **B1.**

"Funny Girl" at Citizens Opera House succeeds despite some outdated moments, writes Don Aucoin. **G1.**

A STRUGGLE FOR CELTICS

In a rematch of last year's NBA Finals, Boston fell to the shorthanded Dallas Mavericks, 127-120, at TD Garden on Thursday night. The loss dropped their home record to 16-10, a far cry from last season when they were 37-4. **C1.**



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF



Blown opportunity

Friday: Warmer but windy. High 34-39. Low 20-25.
Saturday: Snow late. High 32-37. Low 26-31.
Sunrise: 6:51 Sunset: 5:06
Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

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